Teruma 5784

פרשת תרומה is the famous פרשה that discusses the building of the משכן. The second פסוק reads: דַּבֵּר אֶל בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וְיִקְחוּ לִי תְּרוּמָה מֵאֵת כָּל אִישׁ אֲשֶׁר יִדְּבֶנּוּ לִבּוֹ תִּקְחוּ אֶת תְּרוּמָתִי. The מפרשים discuss this פסוק in great detail: What is the requirement for the contributions to the משכן? The אזנים לתורה writes that the main quality of the משכן was the נדיבת לב, every single piece of material used in the משכן - gold, silver, copper, wood - was given with נדיבת לב, a sincere heart. Why was this נדיבת לב so crucial? Because it was necessary for השראת השכינה - for the שכינה to rest within the משכן.

The אזנים לתורה continues: This is the defining quality of every בית הכנסת. Just as the משכן was built through נדיבת הלב, בתי כנסיות are established when Jews willingly contribute to glorify Hashem's name and create a קידוש השם. This sincerity infuses the תפילות in those בתי כנסיות with a רֵיחַ נִיחוֹחַ that is pleasing to Hashem. All of the institutions that we build on generosity like that fall into that category.

I want to do something unusual - to examine the last פסוק of the פרשה. Typically, the beginning of a פרשה receives all the attention; those פסוקים have the מזל that they're always being quoted. The end of the פרשה is not so מזלדיק. However, let's see what we can glean from this ending.

The last פסוק reads: לְכֹל כְּלֵי הַמִּשְׁכָּן בְּכֹל עֲבֹדָתוֹ וְכָל יְתֵדֹתָיו וְכָל יִתְדֹת הֶחָצֵר נְחֹשֶׁת. This פסוק refers to the חצר, detailing the beams, curtains, hooks, and other elements surrounding it. These components enclosed the חצר, within which stood the משכן itself. רש"י comments on this פסוק: שֶׁהָיוּ צְרִיכִין לַהֲקָמָתוֹ וּלְהוֹרָדָתוֹ - Because you have to put up the חצר and take it down, just like the משכן had to be put up and taken down; כְּגוֹן מַקָּבוֹת לְתַקֵּעַ יְתֵדוֹת וְעַמּוּדִים - All of the instruments and all of the equipment, the utensils that were required to put the משכן up and then take it down, they had to be made out of נחושת. And not only that, the hammers as well, and the pins, the יִתְדֹת. So in the next רש"י he goes on the word יִתְדֹת, and he says: כְּמִין נִגְרֵי נְחֹשֶׁת עֲשׂוּיִין לִירִיעוֹת הָאֹהֶל - pegs of copper to make for the יְרִיעוֹת of the אֹהֶל. רש"י then asks a question, he's not sure if the curtains were fixed into the ground, whether when they hung the curtains were there pins both on the top and the bottom, or were the curtains only secured at the top and their weight held them down? So רש"י brings a ראיה: וְאוֹמֵר אֲנִי שֶׁשְּׁמָן מוֹכִיחַ עֲלֵיהֶם - Their very name gives away and reveals what their purpose was, and what their use was; שֶׁהֵם תְּקוּעִים בָּאָרֶץ - That they were fastened into the ground, stuck into the ground; לְכָךְ נִקְרְאוּ יְתֵדוֹת - That's what they're called יְתֵדוֹת, which means pins. And then he brings down a פסוק from ישעיה: וּמִקְרָא זֶה מְסַיְּעֵנִי. That's what I thought was quite fascinating. And the פסוק in (ישעיה ל״ג:כ׳) that רש"י brings is: אֹהֶל בַּל יִצָּעֶן - a tent shall not be removed; בַּל יִסַּע יְתֵדֹתָיו - And the יתדות will never be taken out; לָנֶצַח - forever. So the last רש"י in תרומה, the last word of that רש"י is לָנֶצַח, forever, and I thought this is quite fascinating (This is my vort, לענית דעתי, I hope I'm not wrong). רש"י's implication here is that all this נדיבת לב, all the heartfelt generosity, was given for what? A משכן - a temporary structure that would only exist during the time בני ישראל were in the מדבר. How could people be enthusiastic about contributing to something with such a finite lifespan? Typically, we donate to causes we believe will last for נצחיות. We want our contributions to have lasting value. What is רש"י teaching us by quoting this פסוק?

Yes, the משכן was temporary, but it was the forerunner of both בתי מקדש. Many elements of the משכן - the מנורה, the ארון, מזבח הזהב, and even the כיור - were transferred to the בית המקדש. There was an undeniable and significant element of נצחיות inherent in the משכן. More broadly, anything given for הקדוש ברוך הוא gains נצחיות automatically. What may seem temporary to us becomes eternal through Hashem's projects. We, on the other hand, are finite beings. Yet, we achieve נצחיות through our children and אייניקלעך, and through our מצוות performed with נדיבת לב. This is the beautiful connection between the beginning and the end of פרשת תרומה.

https://youtu.be/hAslropINn8